

Research: Titles and Abstracts

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1. **The Cost of Affordability: Simulating Lifetime Earnings Losses from Housing Cost-Burden Preservation**

This paper uses a lifecycle simulation of two agents to quantify how preserving a target housing cost-to-income ratio under means-tested housing subsidies can induce large forgone earnings. Agents face a trade-off between short-run affordability (keeping rent burden low via subsidy eligibility) and long-run income growth. Results show that rational or quasi-rational decisions to suppress earnings growth in order to remain under subsidy-relevant burden thresholds can compound into millions of dollars in lifetime earnings losses. The simulation isolates housing cost-burden preservation as the decision rule and traces cumulative effects on wages, human capital accumulation, and lifetime income trajectories.

2. **The Hidden Cost of Income Limits: A Welfare Comparison of Housing Subsidy Designs**

This paper compares the deadweight loss of two dominant housing subsidy designs, flat subsidized rent below an income threshold and rent as a percent of income below a threshold, against an uncapped percent-of-income alternative. Using standard public-finance tools for notches and kinks, it shows that income caps create extensive-margin distortions and bunching at eligibility boundaries. An uncapped percent-of-income schedule removes the cliff and dominates both capped programs on welfare grounds. Adding mobility frictions strengthens that dominance by locking households into suboptimal locations near binding thresholds, and a final analysis examines behavioral responses as incomes press program limits.

3. **Degree of Overpricing, Buyer Arrivals, and Time-on-Market: A Simultaneous-Equations Approach**

This paper reexamines the joint determination of pricing and marketing time by treating degree of overpricing (DOP), buyer arrivals, and time-on-market (TOM) as simultaneously determined. Rather than treating list price or sale price as exogenous drivers of DOM, it models DOP as the seller's key choice variable and buyer arrivals as an endogenous market response. A simultaneous-equations framework identifies how initial overpricing affects arrival intensity and how arrival intensity feeds back into marketing duration and eventual sale outcomes. The approach clarifies why reduced-form price-DOM estimates often conflict across studies and provides a structural path from pricing strategy to transaction performance.

4. **Estimating Unobservable Buyer Demand: An Inventory-Based Approach**

The number of active buyers in a local housing market is almost never directly observed, yet it is central to search, pricing, and time-on-market models. This paper proposes an inventory-based proxy for

market-level buyer demand, building from average days of inventory and related absorption measures. Drawing an analogy to labor-market tightness (vacancy duration versus job seekers), it constructs and validates a measure of buyer-side market depth that can be implemented with standard MLS inventory data. The contribution is primarily methodological: a transparent, replicable proxy for an otherwise latent demand stock that can be used in TOM, pricing, and market-condition research.

5. Rethinking the Price-DOM Relationship: Is It Linear After All?

The price-“days-on-market literature has long disagreed on sign while largely agreeing on functional form: studies report both positive and negative associations, but almost always under linear specifications. This paper revisits that consensus by testing whether the price-“DOM relationship is nonlinear. If the true relationship is U-shaped, inverted-U, or regime-dependent, conflicting signs in prior work may reflect different samples of a common nonlinear surface rather than genuine economic disagreement. Using flexible functional forms, the paper reassesses the shape of the relationship and discusses implications for pricing strategy and for models that treat price and marketing time as jointly determined.

6. Announcement, Removal, and Market Response: An Event Study of the NAR Commission Settlement

This event study examines whether the NAR commission settlement affected housing markets at three economically distinct moments: settlement announcement, announcement that MLS cooperating compensation fields would be removed, and actual removal of cooperating fees from MLS systems. The design separates information effects (announcement windows) from mechanical implementation effects (removal date), and can exploit staggered MLS compliance where timing differs across markets. Outcomes of interest include transaction volume, marketing time, list-to-sale ratios, and commission-related listing practices. The paper provides early systematic evidence on whether commission-structure reform was priced into residential markets and when.

7. Homogeneous Versus Heterogeneous Goods: Testing Agent Performance in Condo and Single-Family Transactions

Agent value-added should matter more when properties are harder to value. Single-family homes are highly heterogeneous in lot, condition, and finishes, while condos are more standardized and comparable within buildings or complexes. This paper tests whether agent performance, measured via price, time-on-market, and sale probability relative to hedonic benchmarks, differs systematically between the two property types. A larger and more variable agent effect in the single-family segment would support an information-and-expertise channel; a null difference would suggest that agent effects operate mainly through marketing, networks, or negotiation rather than resolution of property-specific uncertainty.

8. Firing the Agent: Does Switching After Poor Performance Actually Help?

Sellers who experience poor listing outcomes often switch agents, implicitly betting that underperformance reflects agent quality rather than bad luck or adverse market conditions. This paper asks whether switching after poor performance improves subsequent outcomes, or whether apparent improvement is largely regression to the mean. Linking sequential listings and agent changes in MLS data, it separates skill-based gains from mean reversion and market-cycle effects. The results speak to whether sellers can learn about agent quality from noisy performance signals and whether the costly decision to fire the agent systematically pays off.

9. How Agent Markets Form and Evolve: Spatial Concentration, Competitor Entry, and Inventory Shocks in Residential Brokerage

This paper studies how residential agent markets form and change over space and time. It examines spatial concentration of agent activity, entry by competitors, and responses to inventory shocks, treating the local brokerage market as an evolving competitive environment rather than a fixed backdrop. The analysis links agent geographic footprints and market polygons to entry, exit, and performance dynamics. By documenting how agent markets thicken, thin, and reconfigure, the paper provides a market-structure foundation for research on agent value, specialization, and client outcomes.

10. Repricing to Sell: The Effects of List Price Changes on Price, Time-on-Market, and Sale Likelihood

Sellers frequently revise list prices during a marketing spell, yet the effects of repricing on final sale price, remaining time-on-market, and sale probability remain incompletely understood. This paper estimates how list-price reductions (and increases) affect transaction outcomes, accounting for endogenous timing of revisions and for information revealed by initial buyer response. The analysis distinguishes strategic price discovery from distress-driven discounting and quantifies trade-offs among price concession, marketing duration, and sale likelihood. Results inform optimal dynamic pricing strategies for sellers and agents during an active listing.

11. Jack of All Trades or Master of One? Agent Specialization and Client Performance in Residential Brokerage

Residential agents differ sharply in whether they specialize by property type, price segment, geography, or client side (buyer versus seller). This paper measures specialization from transaction histories and tests whether specialist agents deliver better client outcomes than generalists. Performance is evaluated on price, time-on-market, and sale probability, with attention to selection of agents into niches and of clients into agent types. The central question is whether depth of focus (master of one) outperforms breadth (jack of all trades) in residential brokerage, and under what market conditions specialization premiums appear.

12. Seller Timing Decisions Reconsidered: The Listing Date, Not the Sale Date, Drives Outcomes

Much of the seasonality literature treats sale timing as if it were a seller choice. In practice, sellers choose when to list; once listed, buyer arrivals and competing inventory largely determine when a sale occurs. This paper reframes seller timing as a listing-date decision and estimates which listing months maximize price, minimize days on market, and raise sale probability. By separating the controllable decision (list date) from the market-determined outcome (sale date), it clarifies the true margins of seller influence and revisits seasonal thick-market effects from the correct decision node.

13. Diminishing Returns at the Top: School Quality, Price Appreciation, and the Limits of Capitalization

The capitalization of school quality into house prices is well established; less is known about dynamics. This paper tests whether price appreciation differs across the school-quality distribution, with particular attention to whether top districts exhibit compressed appreciation because little quality "upside" remains to be priced in. It also estimates how long school-performance changes take to appear in prices, whether redistricting can be anticipated and front-run, and how proximity to private schools interacts with public-school capitalization. The contribution is a dynamic, nonlinear view of school-quality capitalization beyond the static premium.

14. Local Expertise or Undiversified Risk? Geographic Concentration and REIT Returns

REIT geographic focus is often framed purely as a diversification choice. This paper instead treats concentration, measured at zip, MSA, and CBSA levels using HHI and related metrics, as a potential signal of managerial skill analogous to concentrated "stock picking" in active asset management. It tests whether geographic concentration is associated with excess returns after standard risk controls, and whether any premium is consistent with local information advantages rather than simple undiversified exposure. Multi-scale measurement allows the concentration performance relationship to vary with spatial granularity, sharpening the skill-versus-risk interpretation.

15. An Unintended Instrument of Exclusion: How Septic-Driven Lot Minimums Caused Residential Segregation

Private septic systems require larger lots for leach fields and setbacks, creating an engineering rationale for large-lot development that can produce exclusionary demographic outcomes without explicit discriminatory zoning language. This paper provides causal evidence that septic-driven lot minimums increased residential segregation as an unintended consequence of an ostensibly neutral infrastructure standard. Identification separates infrastructure constraints from municipal preferences over density and composition, and documents demographic sorting along the public-sewer versus private-septic margin. The result identifies a technologically mediated channel of exclusion in the land-use and segregation literature.

16. The Relationship Between Rental Housing Share and Neighborhood Characteristics

This paper examines associations between rental housing concentration and neighborhood characteristics across school performance, demographic composition, and income distribution. At an early stage, the analysis is intentionally descriptive: it documents patterns linking tenure mix to local community attributes without asserting a settled causal hierarchy. Findings are positioned against the homeownership-externality and neighborhood-effects literatures, with attention to composition versus change over time. The paper provides a baseline map of how rental share co-varies with schools, demographics, and income, and clarifies where stronger identification will be needed for causal claims.

17. Are Neighborhoods Always Local? Redefining Housing Market Competition Beyond Distance

Housing research typically defines competitive sets by distance (e.g., within one mile) or administrative boundaries. This paper asks whether multidimensional similarity, property attributes, amenity access, local demographics, school quality, and property taxes, better defines the relevant market than physical proximity alone. It constructs characteristics-based competitor sets and compares them with distance-based definitions in predicting price co-movement and competitive outcomes. If similarity dominates distance, standard practices for comps, hedonics, and "local market" fixed effects may systematically mismeasure substitution and competition.

18. Disclosing Agent Ownership Interest: Variation in Transparency Across MLS Platforms

Disclosure of agent ownership interest is nearly universal in licensing and ethics rules, but implementation clarity varies widely across MLS platforms. This paper audits how agent-interest disclosures are structured, labeled, and made searchable across multiple MLS systems, treating disclosure quality as a measurable institutional variable rather than a binary legal requirement. Cross-platform comparison documents gaps between the rule on paper and transparency in practice. The study establishes a compliance-and-transparency baseline for subsequent work on whether disclosure clarity affects transaction outcomes.

19. Natural Disasters as Catalysts for Redevelopment

Natural disasters destroy capital stock but may also lower redevelopment costs, unlock emergency rezoning and public support, and compress approval timelines relative to non-disaster counterfactuals. This exploratory paper assesses whether disasters act as catalysts for redevelopment through cost, regulatory, and speed channels. Because clean counterfactuals are difficult, the analysis emphasizes descriptive and quasi-experimental designs around disaster declarations, recovery programs, and permitting outcomes. The contribution is a structured evaluation of when, and through which mechanisms, destruction coincides with accelerated rebuilding and land-use change.
